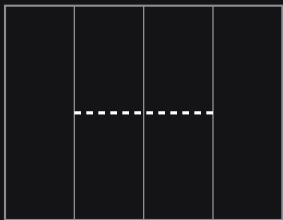


HOW TO MAKE A ZINE

one sheet of paper
eight pages
nobody's permission



eight panels, one cut
fold along the dotted lines of your life

WHAT IS A ZINE?

A zine is a small thing you made and handed to someone.

That is the entire definition.

No publisher. No editor. No ISBN. No print run. No subject too small – there are zines about a single bus route.

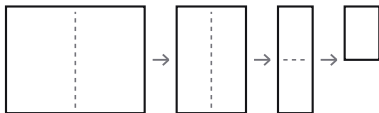
It is the cheapest way to put something into the world and the only one where nobody gets to say no first.

If you are waiting to be qualified: you already are.

FOLD IT FIRST

Fold a blank sheet into a zine before you write a single word.

Eight small pages are far less frightening than one big empty one, and you can see exactly how much room you have.



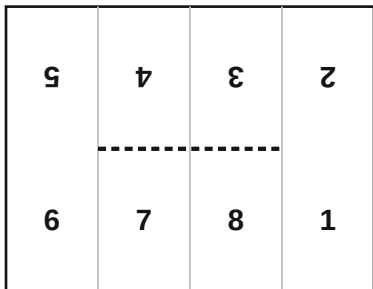
In half, in half, in half again. Unfold. Cut the middle. Fold it back up.

Now pencil a number in each panel. You are no longer facing a blank page – you are filling in eight small boxes.

THE WEIRD PART

Unfold a finished zine and the page numbers look wrong. Half are upside down.

Not a mistake – just what folding does. Copy this map:



dashed line = the cut

Page 1 is bottom right. Write the top row upside down and it reads the right way up once folded.

Or let zine-fold.com do it for you.

WHAT GOES IN IT

Anything at all. These reliably work:

- one obsession, explained badly
- a map of somewhere you know too well
- instructions for something useless
- twenty-four hours, hour by hour
- a list you cannot stop adding to
- an apology
- everything you know about one very small thing

Small and specific beats broad and vague. Nobody wants your general thoughts; they want the strange particular one.

MAKE IT ROUGH

Handwriting is fine. Tape is fine.
Crooked is fine. Correction fluid is
a design choice.

Zines look like zines because they
are photocopied: hard blacks,
blown-out greys, the grain of a
fifth-generation copy. Glue
something down and copy it and the
seams vanish.

Polish is a different medium with
different gatekeepers. This one is
supposed to look made.

DONE BEATS GOOD

GET IT OUT

Photocopy it. Black and white costs pennies, and the copy looks better than the original.

Then give it away:

- trade with anyone else making one
- leave stacks in cafés and libraries
- slip one inside a book in a shop
- post one to a stranger

Selling them is allowed. Charging what it cost to copy is traditional. A zine nobody is holding is just paper.

YOU ARE HOLDING ONE.

Now unfold this sheet. The other
side is completely blank.

That is your first zine.

Imposed with zine-fold.com

Layout: 8-page mini zine

One sheet, single-sided, one cut

Copy this. Change it. Put your
name on it. That is the tradition.